

fueled the darkest regions of the Dreaming, sending forth vast numbers of nightmare creatures to besiege the fae, who were already focused on their own conflict.

In the early 14th century, the Autumn world entered a new era that would eventually transition into the Renaissance. As scientific methods began to explain what mortals previously considered magic, the common folk took to the church's teachings, forswearing their old ways in exchange for salvation and a steadfast faith on which to cling in the darkest days. Increasing numbers of gateways shattered, and the fae realized they would have to make one of three choices that would determine their destiny forever.

Many retreated into their domains — faerie glens as well as strongholds — in the Autumn world and sealed all connections with the world outside of their own accord. Locked inside their unchanging realms, they grew mad from their own Glamour, transitioning into Lost Ones (p. 314).

The ruling fae, with the exception of nobility in Houses Liam and Scathach, fled to Arcadia, the homeland and birthplace of the fae, through the last remaining portal, while forcing commoner fae to wait while the influential secured their survival. These escapes were not orderly, and frantic battles at the gateways delayed departure from the Autumn world, adding to the unnecessary casualties of the Shattering.

Fae who realized that they wouldn't make it through the portal, or who had lost any safe haven within the Dreaming, made the choice to undergo the Changeling Way, a magical ritual that entwined the faerie soul with a mortal coil, transforming their immortality into an endless cycle of rebirth. Now hiding in the veneer of Banality, the Kithain — changelings — awoke to a harsh new world.

The Interregnum

The history of the Kithain is the story of ebb and tide of Glamour and Banality. No period depicts this as thoroughly as the Interregnum. The cataclysmic events initiated by the Shattering continued to decrease the Dreaming's influence. Many changelings described the sensation as if the Autumn world itself attempted to suffocate their very souls. The church continued its efforts to rid the world of unwanted influence, and vast numbers of changelings attempted to circumvent discovery by hiding in plain sight.

Most changelings were furious at the sidhe on the whole, and the Autumn sidhe — those few that stayed on Earth — found themselves the targets of unwarranted attacks. In time, though, their very presence changed the mind of commoners; they had stayed willingly, after all, to fulfill their obligations to their subjects. To avoid further casualties, the Seelie and Unseelie Courts negotiated an indefinite truce in their ancient conflict. This treaty, known to Kithain as the Compact (p. 57), meant that hostilities ceased, making it possible to travel between dominions without fearing reprisals due to court affinity, a tradition that remains crucial to changeling society even in modern times.

As the 14th century ended, the Renaissance blossomed, bringing a renewed flow of Glamour to the Autumn world. Left with a feudal paradigm they were accustomed to, but that mortals had largely abandoned, commoners and Autumn sidhe decided to fill the void of power by assuming control of empty seats of power. Realizing their precarious situation, the Autumn sidhe made no claims on or attempts to diminish the accomplishments of their fellow Kithain. Nonetheless, changeling society reflected the alterations in the mortal world, and when merchant classes grew in power, many commoners abandoned old titles and customs, intent on modernizing their classical feudal paradigm. Some fae, unable or unwilling to adapt to this shift, took to the road, wandering from location to location, or taking work as caravan guards or travelling artists.

The Age of Exploration revived a sense of curiosity in the Kithain, and some joined navies in hope of discovering fragments of the Dreaming in places untouched by Banality. Excitement over and dreams of marvelous discoveries among the mortals were reflected in the Dreaming by the initiation of the restoration of shattered trods, making it possible for the Kithain to once more visit locations inside the Dreaming. Artists such as Leonardo da Vinci and Michelangelo infused the world with Glamour, alongside writers like Shakespeare and Christopher Marlowe.

The Age of Reason proved a double-edged sword for changelings. While hiding in the mortal guises of soldiers, politicians, artists, and craftsmen, the fae enjoyed Glamour of musicians and poets, while allowing them to secretly move against humanity and guiding them carefully from the shadows. At the same time, many of the new dreams that filled mortal minds left no place for the wondrous and magical, relegating the existence of changelings to fairytale nonsense. Expansive and developing technological achievements proved a powerful lure for nockers and other crafters, and during the Age of Inventions, these changelings increased their influence over other commoners.

Villages grew into towns while towns became cities, and farmers turned into workers of the industrial age. At first, Glamour flourished as technological advancements made life easier for the common man. Wondrous new gadgets and objects entered the market in a steady flow, but the downside of these fantastic developments was the smoke, the dreary and difficult lives in factories, and the spreading of diseases as cities continued to expand and attract citizens from across counties and nations. By the turn of the 20th century, late in the Age of Romance, the world shifted again, and slowly, but steadily, in the advantage of Banality.

Following the outbreak of the Great War, changelings joined mortals in the battlefield on both sides, and the dark, bitter Glamour born of it briefly surged before Banality drained even the most vicious Kithain of almost all hope. The war brought up old grievances between the courts, briefly increasing tensions, but mortals brokered peace and the survivors returned to rebuild the ruins of their old lives.

Although the Roaring 20s gave a brief respite from Banality's grip, the Great Depression diminished Glamour once again.